A vigorous participation in existing mechanisms and the invention of new ones helps to address this challenge. The Quad and FIPIC in the Indo-Pacific, the I2U2 in West Asia, and the India–Nordic Summit in Europe are relevant examples at the highest level. The IMEC is the latest in the list. Those with ASEAN, the EU, Africa and BRICS have, of course, continued apace. But these are now also supplemented at ministerial levels by formats with Central Europe, Caribbean and Central America. As with Europe and the rest of Asia, we can relate more purposefully to broader geographies like Africa and Latin America by dealing with sub-regions. The opening of new embassies, especially in Africa, is part of the same endeavour.

An important source of strength is the growth in investments, trade and projects of Indian businesses abroad. India is today among the top five economic partners of many countries of Africa and Latin America. The movement of our professionals is adding an additional layer to many relationships. Similarly, development projects supported through grants and soft loans across 78 nations of the Global South demonstrate capability as much as a solution to a local need. Quite apart from our national branding, it is the presence on the ground in so many manifestations that is imprinting India in the mind space of societies even far away.

The spatial *mandala* is accompanied by a conceptual one. Indian foreign policy today recognizes more explicitly the imperatives of national security in setting priorities and making choices. But security itself is perceived in much broader and deeper terms. AatmaNirbhar Bharat Abhiyan and Make in India are neither economic protectionism nor political slogans. They are, in fact, a quest to build deeper strengths and greater strategic autonomy that is required by a nation aspiring to be a leading power. Increasingly, economic security also cohabits with technological security.

The digital domain is its most visible expression, though obviously far from being the only one. India’s goal is not of moving the needle in the direction of autarky but, instead, to create the capabilities that would make it a serious player at a global level. The demand for resilient and reliable supply chains are a chance that could be exploited with the right policies. Similarly, the knowledge economy is its big opportunity, and transparent and trusted data flows assign a value to India that must be fully appreciated. Participating more intensively in the global economy will not just require better preparations and the right outlook but also the appropriate human resources.